

ADS: Apocalypse Delivery Service

a solo journalling microTTRPG by Will Kibel

The Premise

You are a delivery person in the year 2026, only a few years after a significant apocalyptic event forced humanity to retreat to bunkers and shelters. You, working for the ADS, are one of those people responsible for bringing packages from one point to another, keeping people connected from afar.

The Game

While you make your deliveries for ADS, you keep a journal. It's company policy - not for the sake of their record-keeping, but for the sake of your own sanity-keeping. As you work to reach your delivery quota, you will record each delivery in your journal. You *just* ran out of space in your old journal, so consider making this the start of a brand new one.

You

Start your journal with a brief introduction. Start with your name and how long you've been employed by ADS (likely only a few years, if that). Then, pick one quality from the following:

- cynical, optimistic, lazy, depressed, confused, whimsical, philosophical, anxious, comic, elitist, lonesome...

...or come up with your own key character trait. If there are any other details you find important about yourself, write them down.

In addition, roll a D6 to find your quota. Your quota is the number of deliveries ADS will require you to make as part of your contract. *The game ends when you have delivered your quota plus one.*

Deliveries

To start a new delivery, pick up a package from the delivery station. Choose whichever one you want, either randomly or deliberately. Record the package information (to, from, items, any special indicators) as the start of your next journal entry. Then, set out on your journey.

The Journey

You're given plenty of time to ponder as you carry your cargo across the landscape. First, take some time to notice things you see as you go. If you like, roll a D20 to determine what you notice, or select something at random, from the Apocalypse Feature Chart. In your journal, mark down what you encountered, how you engaged with it, and what it meant to you.

You can encounter more than one thing per delivery, if you want. Some encounters are more dangerous than others, so remember that not every delivery has to be successful (although only successful deliveries add to your quota).

More importantly, however, is that the solitude of delivery has made you introspective - think about the meaning behind the delivery. Why is the person sending this package? How will the recipient feel when it arrives? Does it remind you of anything in your life? Does it remind you of anything about the world (or the end thereof?) In your journal, record how you feel as you trek.

When your journey is complete, mark the package as delivered in your journal. If anything happened to it along the way, mark that down as well.

The End

You may hit your quota of deliveries - but you won't be done yet. When you reach that point, select a High Priority Delivery. This is your most intense delivery yet - select twice as many encounters and think more about what the delivery means to you.

When you have delivered the final package, mark down that your shift is over. Then, write down why you decided to join ADS and turn in your journal to your shift supervisor.

Thanks for delivering! You make us whole.

Delivery Station

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1. Ceramic plates (6)
G. Smith, West Quadrant
S. Evans, Point Deep Blue
(FRAGILE) | 11. Cartography set
V. Ramos, Formica
J. Roberts, Rovstom |
| 2. Blender
T. Thorson, Loch Gaelor
P. Ogden, Northern Storm | 12. Postcard
A. Kuster, Mountain Pass
M. Peña, Northern Storm |
| 3. Leftover Chinese food
R. Whitaker, Rovstom
Z. Cary, Mountain Pass
(PERISHABLE) | 13. Case of liquor
L. Vincent, Metal Hull
B. Varga, Loch Gaelor
(PERISHABLE) |
| 4. Sci-fi novels
T. Thorson, Loch Gaelor
V. Thorson, Mountain Pass | 14. Safari hat
A. Kuo, West Quadrant
S. Hahn, Formica |
| 5. Lego Millenium Falcon
O. Pyzynski, Formica
S. Cifarelli, Point Deep Blue | 15. Steak cutlets
G. Barter, Loch Gaelor
T. Hudson, Point Deep Blue
(PERISHABLE) |
| 6. Coffee mug
G. Rafferty, Rovstom
P. Stevenson, Northern Storm
(FRAGILE) | 16. Paintbrushes
H. Perry, Rovstom
L. Frasier, Metal Hull |
| 7. Plush animal
W. Alexander, Point Deep Blue
B. Stefanie, Formica | 17. Acoustic guitar
C. Winston, Mountain Pass
L. Bergamini, Formica
(FRAGILE) |
| 8. Magnet set
K. Polachek, Metal Hull
F. Polachek, West Quadrant | 18. Miniature cactus
J. Yoshimura, West Quadrant
R. Yoshimura, Northern Storm |
| 9. Fantasy novels
T. Thorson, West Quadrant
B. Slaw, Rovstom | 19. Painting of Loch Gaelor
O. Columbia, Loch Gaelor
I. Martin, Mountain Pass |
| 10. Jigsaw puzzle
J. Fu, Mountain Pass
L. Light, Northern Storm | 20. Umbrella
V. Oshry, Rovstom
T. Powell, Loch Gaelor |

High Priority Deliveries

1. Kidney - T. Thorson
Loch Gaelor General Medical
Mountain Pass Medical & Surgery
(PERISHABLE) (FRAGILE)
2. Ashes - Unknown
L. Rosenberg, Northern Storm
Loch Gaelor Overlook
3. Chemical compounds
S. Morse, Formica
B. Raehse, Loch Gaelor
(FRAGILE)
4. Lost rain jacket
B. Berida, Northern Storm
B. Johnston, Point Deep Blue
5. Atomic ammunition
X. Francis, Metal Hull
X. Francis, Rovstom
(FRAGILE)
6. Initialed designer watch
S. Alexander, Rovstom
P. Edwards, Northern Storm
7. Bunker rations
T. Williams, Loch Gaelor
L. Porter, Nu Ranch Outpost
8. High-amperage batteries
N. Stateman, Formica
V. Roslin, West Quadrant
9. [redacted]
West Quadrant Checkpoint
The Edge
(FRAGILE)
10. Unmarked, moving
XXXXXXX, Northern Storm
XXXXXXX, Loch Gaelor
(FRAGILE) (PERISHABLE)

Apocalypse Feature Chart

1. Hands reach up from the sand, grasping for something that isn't there.
2. A windstorm sweeps through the dense underbrush, rocking you from side to side.
3. You pass a dam, frozen over. Icicles jut out in every direction from the concrete structure.
4. A reptilian silhouette flits across your vision.
5. Two birds with abnormally long beaks fly together across the mountains.
6. You encounter a hologram message from someone long dead.
7. A sinkhole opens up in front of you, engulfing the path you were about to walk on.
8. A whisper is carried on the wind. It falls on deaf ears.
9. A sonic disruption pervades the air around you. Your vision blurs.
10. Ghosts float around you, on their way to a common destination.
11. A strange melody whistles through the trees. It sounds... familiar?
12. You see an old tree split in half from a lightning strike.
13. A delivery robot overtakes you. The future is automated.
14. You see a prehistoric creature roaming the landscape.
15. You see a posthistoric creature roaming the landscape.
16. An inverted thunderstorm sucks the water from the earth up into the sky.
17. You come across a structure you recognize. Within this structure, you find a memento of a past life.
18. You call out into the open air. There is no response, only a dense silence.
19. The world remembers what humanity forgot.
20. A dream - or a nightmare - turns to reality. Your package, mysteriously, changes.